

Shamsa Kanwal

Psychology Graduate | Research & Clinical Psychology

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (BS) in Psychology

Spring 2022 – Fall 2025

Virtual University of Pakistan · CGPA 3.10 / 4.00 · 133 credit hours · Degree conferred 6 July 2026

Relevant coursework: Research Methods in Psychology, Experimental Psychology, Statistical Packages (SPSS), Psychological Testing and Measurement, Clinical Psychology, Health Psychology, Abnormal Psychology, Developmental Psychology, Cognitive Psychology, Social Psychology, Personality Psychology, Organizational Psychology.

RESEARCH

Relationship Between Self-Esteem and Life Satisfaction Among Diabetic Patients

2025

PSY499 — Final Year Research Project, Department of Psychology, Virtual University of Pakistan. Supervisor: Ms. Muskan Zahra. Group research project completed by a team of four undergraduate students.

Self-esteem and life satisfaction showed a strong, statistically significant positive correlation ($r = .674$, $p < .01$): patients with higher self-esteem tended to report greater satisfaction with life.

- Literature review and development of the research proposal
 - Data collection from diabetic patients — approximately 150 of the 200 responses
 - Managing participant responses, data entry and cleaning
 - Statistical analysis in SPSS and interpretation of findings
 - Writing the research report
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CLINICAL AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Clinical Psychology Intern

1 April 2025 – 12 June 2025

Isfandiyar Bukhari District Hospital (DHQ), Attock

Supervised clinical psychology training completed as part of the BS Psychology degree, applying coursework concepts within a hospital setting. Under the supervision of qualified clinical psychologists, including Dr Humma Ghalib.

- Patient interaction and professional rapport building
- Clinical interviewing, intake and case history taking
- Mental Status Examination (MSE) under supervision
- Behavioural observation and clinical documentation

Continued Supervised Clinical Experience & Intern Coordination

After June 2025

Isfandiyar Bukhari District Hospital (DHQ), Attock

After the internship I continued to gain supervised clinical exposure at the same hospital and supported coordination of clinical psychology interns. Under the supervision of senior clinical psychologists.

- Continued supervised practice in intake assessment, case history taking, MSE and behavioural observation
- Supervised exposure to DSM-5-based case formulation and personality assessment
- Clinical case discussions, ward rounds and case record management
- Administrator of the department's clinical psychology interns' communication group: sharing announcements, schedules and documents

Clinical Psychology Intern (online, with practical exposure)

20 October 2025 – 3 January 2026

MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC)

Two-month clinical psychology internship organised by MindWise Psychologist Community, conducted online with practical exposure. Under the supervision of Mr. Niaz Ahmad (Clinical Psychologist).

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Active Citizenship: Pathways to Healing

2025

PSY612 — Active Citizenship. Group community-based project with women living in a shelter-home setting. I contributed the literature review section on art therapy and psychological healing, and helped plan and facilitate art-based activities: My Inner World, Safe Places, Freedom and Hope, and My Identity.

Clinical Internship Case Report

2025

PSY619 — Internship in Clinical Psychology. Supervised case study prepared during my clinical internship, covering background history, presenting complaints, Mental Status Examination, informal and formal assessment, DSM-5-based formulation, prognosis and management plan.

SKILLS

Research	Quantitative research design, Literature review, Questionnaire-based data collection, Informed consent procedures, Data entry and cleaning, Scientific report writing
Statistics	SPSS, Descriptive statistics, Cronbach's alpha, Pearson correlation, Independent samples t-test
Assessment (supervised)	Clinical interviewing, Case history taking, Mental Status Examination, Behavioural observation, RSES, SWLS, Clinical documentation
Professional	Confidentiality and ethics, Professional communication, Team coordination, Multidisciplinary collaboration
Languages	English (medium of instruction)

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATES

Certificate of Internship — Clinical Psychology — MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC), Issued 15 January 2026

Workshop on Psychological First Aid Training — Warda's Mind Care Institute, in collaboration with University of Buner, 2 September 2025

Healing Through Community: Why We Grow Better Together — MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC), 20 September 2025

The Effect of Drug Abuse and Addiction — MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC), 2 October 2025

Breaking the Stigma: Let's Talk About Mental Health — MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC), 10 October 2025

Adult Suicide Crises: A Solution from Psychological Perspective — MindWise Psychologist Community (MPC), Date not stated on certificate

Mental Health Awareness Workshop — College of Nursing, DHQ Hospital, Attock, 15 September 2025 (no certificate issued)

PAVE Community — Psychological Awareness & Volunteer Efforts — PAVE Community, Attock, 26 October 2025 (no certificate issued)

AWARDS

HEC Laptop Scheme

Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan. Educational laptop awarded through the Virtual University of Pakistan on the basis of academic eligibility.

REFERENCES

Two academic references from faculty of the Department of Psychology, Virtual University of Pakistan, are available on request.